

simple Python program file which will help to locate any file in the whole system, including external devices such as a pen drive. This Python file is built as an executable and placed in the Windows folder. The command *locate* is run with a combination of search strings such as the name of the file.

Given below is the code for the *Locate* program in Python:

```
Locate.py
import os
import re
import sys
from datetime import datetime

response = os.popen("wmic logicaldisk get caption")
list1 = []
for line in response.readlines():
    line = line.strip("\n") # this line strip
the \n
    line = line.strip("\r") # this line strip the
\r means carriage return
    line = line.strip(" ") # use to
strip blank space
    if (line == "Caption" or line == ""): # if
caption and "" appears this line ignore
        continue
    list1.append(line) # list1 now contain all
drives of windows
a = "\\\"
def search1(list1):
    tf = 0
    td = 0
    for each in list1: # take each drive
one by one
        print "In ", each
        for root, dir, files in
os.walk(each, topdown = True): # this line return the root
dir (means start from drive), sub directory and files in the
root dir
            for file in files:
# start search from files
                if
re.search(sys.argv[1].lower(), file.lower()): # this line
match the substring given in command line argument with files
one by one
                    print root+file # if match found then make a path to print

tf = tf+1 # to count the files

for d in dir:
if
re.search(sys.argv[1].lower(), d.lower()):
# this line for directories
```

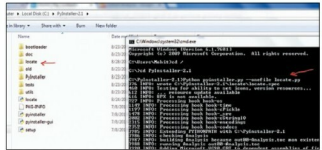


Figure 1: Output of *pyinstaller.py*

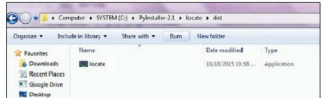


Figure 2: *Locate* command using the command prompt

```
print root+a+d #print the path

td = td+1 # print the number of dirs matched
print "Total File(s) are ", tf
print "Total Directories are ", td
print "\nThank you for using 14wisd.com\n"

t1 = datetime.now()
search1(list1) # call the function.
t2 = datetime.now()
total = t2-t1 # to calculate the total time taken in process
print "Searching completed in ", total
```

Place the *locate.py* file in the Pyinstaller folder and open the command prompt. Go to the Pyinstaller folder and then execute the following command:

```
C:\PyInstall-2.1>Python pyinstaller.py --onefile locate.py
```

After running the command, you will get an output as shown in Figure 1.

Place the *locate.exe* file in the Windows folder of the system. This will make the system automatically pick the file through the Windows path variable. Now, go to the *run* command and provide the command *locate*, along with the file name you are looking for. If you don't remember the file name, then this command also takes the *search* query, as shown in Figure 2. **END** 

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